

Vijith Varatharajan

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Research Interests

Game-based language learning and digital pedagogy • Commercial video games as informal second language acquisition environments • Situated learning in interactive digital contexts • Educational technology and applied linguistics • Digital humanities and narrative design • Player cognition, motivation, and engagement

Education

M.A. English Literature 2021–2023

English and Foreign Languages University (EFLU), Shillong, India | GPA: 7.15/9.0 — Grade: A+

- Relevant dissertation work: constructivist pedagogy and ELT; approaches to digital and interactive media in literary contexts

B.A. English Literature 2018–2021

University of Madras, Chennai, India | GPA: 7.1/10 — Grade: A+

- University Topper — awarded certificate and cash prize

Publications

Under Review

- Varatharajan, V. (under review). Operationalizing constructivism in game-based learning: Implications for second language acquisition. *Australasian Journal of Educational Technology*. Submitted 2026. Estimated first editorial review: 3 weeks.

Creative Publications

- A Story — short story published in the international anthology *Jeremiad of Hearts*.
- Eight Minutes — self-published dystopian science-fiction short story (Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing Literary Contest).
- Pulp Poetry — meta-poetry collection (Bookleaf Publishing).

Master's Research Papers

- “A Constructivist Pedagogical Framework for Teaching English in Contemporary Classrooms”
- “Female Agency and Proto-Feminist Expression in Geoffrey Chaucer’s *The Canterbury Tales*”
- “The Pre-Raphaelite Brotherhood and the Rejection of Academic Dogmatism in Nineteenth-Century Art”

Conference Presentations

- “Revealing the Blue: Analysing Representations of Subtle Casteism in Tamil Films” — COIN Conference Series, National Institute of Technology, November 2022.
- “Revelations of Art: Positioning Art as a Revelatory Tool in the Face of Oppression, Resistance, Survival, and Marginalisation” — COIN Conference Series, National Institute of Technology, November 2024.

Selected Projects

VeloxiLector — Modern Speed-Reading Web Application

- A web-based speed-reading application designed to improve reading fluency and comprehension through progressive exposure techniques and adjustable word-per-minute training.
- Built with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript; deployed via Vercel.
- Live application: veloxilector.vercel.app | Source: github.com/vijithvaratharajan/veloxilector

Spin A Yarn — Dialogue Tree Visualiser and Interactive Fiction Player

- A browser-based application for authoring, visualising, and playtesting branching dialogue scripts of the kind used in commercial narrative and open-world games.
- Features a graph view for visualising narrative branching structure, a play-through mode with keyboard shortcuts, a custom scripting syntax for authoring dialogue branches, file save/load, and six visual themes (Osaka Jade, Tokyo Night, Amber Terminal, Blood Moon, Paper, Deep Ocean) with a CRT terminal aesthetic.
- Built with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript; deployed as a single-file application via Vercel from GitHub.

LexComplex — Lexical Complexity Profiling Tool

- A Streamlit application that profiles the lexical complexity of input text using word frequency data, Academic Word List coverage, and CEFR proficiency band estimation.
- Built with Python and Streamlit, using the wordfreq library and an Academic Word List sublist implementation to estimate text difficulty and learner-appropriate complexity.

SciLit Sonar — Academic Publication Monitoring Tool

- A Streamlit application that monitors and surfaces newly published research relevant to a defined research stream, querying the Semantic Scholar Graph API across target keywords, authors, and venues.
- Built with Python and Streamlit; supports ongoing literature awareness and systematic tracking of newly indexed publications in a chosen research field.

Professional Experience

EdTech Intern — Utter (Language Learning Platform) Jun–Sep 2019

- Utter is an EdTech platform that improves English fluency through conversational chatbots and live tutor sessions.
- Facilitated language acquisition for non-fluent speakers by explaining structural and grammatical patterns through cross-linguistic comparison and comprehensible input techniques.
- Managed multiple simultaneous learners, adapting pedagogical strategies in real time to individual learner needs and proficiency levels.

Freelance Content Writer Apr 2022–Dec 2023

- Produced articles across technology, health, and entertainment verticals; applied SEO optimisation and digital content structuring techniques.

Competitive Examinations & Qualifications

UGC NET (National Eligibility Test) Cleared 2024

University Grants Commission, India

GATE (Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering) Cleared 2024

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Humanities and Social Sciences

Note: The 2023–2024 period was dedicated to preparation and completion of these national examinations.

English Proficiency

IELTS Academic

Overall Band Score: 8.5 | Listening: 9.0 • Reading: 8.5 • Writing: 8.5 • Speaking: 7.5

Certifications and Academic Courses

- CS50x — Harvard University
- DELE A2 Spanish Certification — Instituto Cervantes
- Søren Kierkegaard: Subjectivity, Irony, and the Crisis of Modernity — University of Copenhagen
- Introduction to Who Wrote Shakespeare — University of London
- Postcolonial Literature — IIT Kanpur
- History of English Literature — IIT Madras
- The Popular Gothic Novel — IIT Madras
- Basics of Spanish Language and Culture — IGNOU

Academic and Extracurricular Activities

- President — Film Club, EFLU Shillong: organised film screenings, promoted world cinema; organised Cherry Orchard Film Festival (2022).
- Vice-President — National Service Scheme (NSS), University of Madras: coordinated urban welfare initiatives including blood donation drives, hospital services, and environmental cleanup campaigns.
- Member — Shillong Quizzing Society.
- Multiple prize positions in quizzing and creative writing competitions.

Skills and Languages

Programming & Technical:

Python, C, C++, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Flask, SQLite. Software: MS Office, LibreOffice, Scrivener, Obsidian, VS Code, Vim, GIMP, DaVinci Resolve, OBS Studio. Operating systems: GNU/Linux, Windows, macOS.

Academic Skills:

Academic writing and research; qualitative and quantitative research methods; literary and cultural analysis; digital media and narrative studies.

Languages:

English (Fluent) • Tamil (Fluent) • Spanish (Intermediate) • Malayalam (Conversational)
• Hindi (Conversational)

Personal Website

Portfolio, About Me, My Works, and Contact Details: vijithvaratharajan.github.io